

GOING 3D

From a train jumping out of the screen to current generation 3D - how adding a dimension drastically changed visual media

Back from the days of the Lumiere brothers' 'Arrival of a Train at La Ciotat', where a well-shot short film of a train arriving at a station reportedly sent people screaming and running to the back of the room, Display technology has always been about how realistic it can get. In it's early days, while a major section of research into display technology was about improving the picture quality, there was another part of the research directed towards adding depth perception into the mix. This addition took a 2-Dimensional (Length vs Breadth) form of media and turned it into what we know as 3D (Length vs Breadth vs Depth).

Perceiving depth would go on to let the viewer feel more immersed in the experience, and in present day, it has almost become a basic criteria of any form of visual media that claims to be immersive. Although it has mostly been restricted to the silver screen for a better part of it's lifetime so far, 3D televisions also have been around for a while. From holograms to animated movies, 3D display technology is much more accessible currently than it ever was. To understand why, we first need to know how Stereoscopic 3D works.